New Zealand Rogaining Association Inc.

President's Annual Report 2017/18

This has again been a busy and exciting year for the NZRA. The Association has contributed to the success of no less than 47 rogaine events in New Zealand. We owe great credit to the efforts of committee members Douglas Woods and Colin Dixon who together planned the course for the Heights of Winter Rogaine, arguably the most competitive 12-hour event in the world. On the international stage we were also well-represented with notable successes including Georgia Whitla and Greig Hamilton winning the World Championships in Razna National Park, Latvia. Closer to home Peter Squires and Anne Kennedy took out the mixed ultravet and Richard Robinson and Vivienne Prince in the mixed supervet at the Australasian Championships.

The quality and standard of events has continued to improve over the past 12-months. Significant leaps have been made in the adoption of electronic timing (Navlight and SportIdent) and the up-skilling of organisers in event software by Douglas Woods cannot go unrecognised. With the rising standards comes an expectation of quality mapping, course setting and control placement. In 2018 (and beyond) I see a growing role for experienced and computer savvy rogainers to support the development of new maps. The NZRA should have a role in supporting these people with the software and cartography skills.

In addition to our volunteers we have an emerging trend of the 'professional' rogainer. Largely independent, a handful of individuals in New Zealand are dedicating their lives to furthering our sport. I have been particularly impressed with the marketing that is now yielding unprecedented participation in local events. We now have competing events on weekends, with the upcoming 12hr Poolburn Rogaine and TWALK on 28 April a leading example. Rogaining has transcended from a novel pastime into a competitive sport in its own right.

In both New Zealand and Australia there also is a developing movement of 'hybrid' events, incorporating adventure racing disciplines (mountain biking and kayaking) as well as traditional foot navigation. These events are already bringing new people into the sport. The "City Safari", a metro-rogaine in Wellington is one of the largest events on the annual calendar, and I have personally enjoyed the satisfaction of competing in cycle and paddle rogaines over the past year. In Australia some of the existing rogaining associations have rebranded as "rogaining and adventure racing associations". While I do not see an imminent need to rebrand in New Zealand I am watching this development with interest.

This AGM marks the retirement of Grant Hunter. In 2017 Grant passed his secretary portfolio over to Colin Dixon and has now stepped back from committee duties. On behalf of the committee I would like to thank Grant for a contribution spanning more years than I can possibly remember. On a personal level I would also like to thank him for the invaluable counsel he has provided me. Grant has generously offered to continue to support the Association in a capacity of a rural landowner liaison, and I would like thank him for his continued support.

The 2018 New Zealand Rogaine Championships has been tentatively set for November 24-25th at a location near Dunedin. Eagle-eyed New Zealanders will note that this will be a qualifying race for the 2019 World Championships in Spain. Notwithstanding the 'championship' nature of the event I encourage all rogainers in New Zealand to set the date aside and experience the magic and comradery of navigating under the moonlight. I look forward to seeing you there.

Tim Farrant, President